WELL-RESOURCED SCHOOLS

Rightsizing

LEARNING TARGETS & SUCCESS CRITERIA

LEARNING TARGETS

01 I am learning what the impact of stretching limited resources too thin looks and feels like at each grade band.

02 I am learning how creating well-resourced schools through a rightsizing process could mitigate these impacts.

SUCCESS CRITERIA



I can explain the challenges schools are currently facing as a result of limited resources.



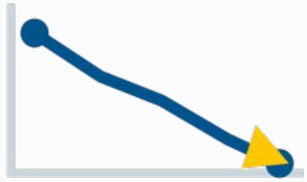
I can describe how rightsizing could help balance out resources and create more equitable learning opportunities at each grade band.

WHY DO WE NEED A RIGHTSIZING PROCESS NOW?

RIGHTSIZING GOAL

Increase stability and improve student learning experience across the system and in every school, especially for historically underserved students.

01



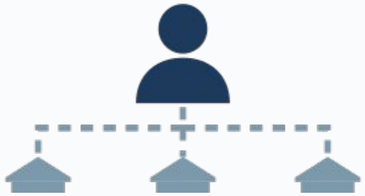
Our enrollment is declining and will continue to decline.

02



We have maintained the same number of school sites.

03



Staff and supports spread both unevenly and thin.

HISTORIC DISTRICT ENROLLMENT CHANGES

SCHOOL CLOSURES SINCE 2000

2000-2004	Whitaker site closed (MS closed in 2005), Youngson K5, Meek K5, Applegate K5, Wilcox K5
2005-2007	Edwards K5, Kenton K5, Smith K5, Clarendon K5, Kellogg MS, Harriet Tubman MS
2008-2012	Marshall HS, Humboldt K5

BROAD SPAN ENROLLMENT PROJECTS (since 2004)

2006 — K8 Reconfiguration
Grade level reconfiguration - 26 K-8s created on the east side

2009-11 — High School System Redesign
Marshall closed; academic program design

2014-17 — District-wide Boundary Review (DBRAC)
Reconfiguration out of K8 and to MS: Harriet Tubman, Roseway Heights; boundary changes

2020-23 — Southeast Enrollment Balancing
Open Kellogg Middle School, boundary changes, grade level reconfiguration, program moves

2025 — Sunsetting Jefferson Dual Assignment
Boundary change

High school closure in 2011 was Marshall and was in conjunction with a district-wide high school redesign process.
Elementary school closure was Humboldt K5 in 2012 as part of consolidation with Boise-Eliot K5.

WHAT HAPPENS IF WE DON'T ACT NOW?

By 2031-2032, most elementary and middle schools will face under-enrollment

1 in 6
K-5 schools with
360+ students



1 in 7
K-8 schools with
500+ students



1 in 8
6-8 schools with
500+ students



Highlighted building = schools meeting the threshold

STRETCHED RESOURCES LEAD TO

- Staff turnover
- Blended classrooms
- Fractured staffing
- Loss of elective and student supports
- Programmatic inequities across schools

EQUITY & ACCESS

for Every Student



THE SAME BASELINE, AT EVERY SCHOOL

Comparable programming across the system, **opportunity that never depends on your address.**

WELL-RESOURCED SCHOOLS

A student-centered definition for sustainable, comparable programming across PPS

STAFFING

- Stable, qualified educators and specialists
- Collaborative schedules and shared planning

SUPPORTS

- Counseling, mental health, nutrition and partnerships
- Culturally specific supports and extracurricular opportunities



PROGRAMMING

- Rigorous, culturally responsive core academics
- Arts, language, PE, athletics, interventions and acceleration

RESOURCES

- Equitable facilities, technology and materials
- Accessible, identity-safe learning environments

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS BY GRADE BAND

Comparable does not mean identical, it means every student can reach a strong, well-supported school experience.

K–5

- 2-3 sections per grade
- Weekly arts, library and PE
- Intervention and tutoring based on need
- Counseling and nursing support on site

6–8

- 6-8 sections per grade
- Full elective rotation: arts, world language
- Intervention based on need
- Counseling and nursing support on site

9–12

- Staffing and courses that support graduation
- 2+ languages, sequential arts, AP/IB/Dual Credit
- 9th grade success and credit recovery
- Counseling and nursing support on site

9TH-12TH GRADE

Sustainable Threshold: ~1,100 students

	PRIOR TO HS REDESIGN (2009-2011)	CURRENT STATE
Academic and College Prep	Inconsistent core course offerings; minimal AP/IB choices; fee-prohibitive or sparse Dual Credit access.	Consistent, aligned core academics for graduation paired with a broad menu of AP, IB, and Dual Credit coursework.
Career Readiness	Few or outdated CTE electives with no clear post-secondary alignment.	Articulated CTE pathways directly linked to high-demand, high-wage career sectors.
Student Supports	Varied and inconsistent supports across high school campuses.	Comprehensive support services, including 9th Grade Success Teams and dedicated access to Social Workers, College Couns./Coordinators and/or Att. Coaches.
Extracurricular and Athletics	Inequitable access to athletics nd extracurriculars, depending on high school campus	Universal access to diverse athletic and extracurricular engagement opportunities.

CURRENT STATE TO WELL-RESOURCED

AN ELEMENTARY STORY (TODAY)

A SCHOOL A

200-350
STUDENTS
K-5

B SCHOOL B

200-350
STUDENTS
K-8, GRADES 6-8 ON SITE

C SCHOOL C

200-350
STUDENTS
K-5, CO-LOCATED DLI



ALL THREE WITHIN A FIVE-MILE RADIUS

THE PINCH OF SHRINKING RESOURCES

- Blended grade bands
- Arts educators split across schools
- Libraries open part of the week
- Limited electives for grades 6-8
- Coaching and intervention reduced
- Principal on duty 2-3 hours a day

CURRENT STATE TO WELL-RESOURCED

AN ELEMENTARY STORY (HYPOTHETICAL FUTURE)

1 CAMPUS 1



360-500
STUDENTS

SINGLE-GRADE CLASSROOMS K-5

2 CAMPUS 2



360-500
STUDENTS

SINGLE-GRADE CLASSROOMS K-5



K-8 SITE → **MIDDLE SCHOOL**

Grades 6-8 to their middle school



DLI STRAND → **NEARBY DLI SITE**

DLI students to a nearby DLI site

WHAT IS NOW TRUE AT EACH IMPACTED SITE

- Single-grade classrooms
- Schoolwide arts program
- Libraries open more consistently
- Coaching and intervention restored
- Grade-level peer teams for all educators
- Principals on instructional leadership

CURRENT STATE TO WELL-RESOURCED

A MIDDLE GRADES STORY (TODAY)

WHERE GRADES 6-8 ARE SERVED

28
SCHOOL SITES



K-8 6-8 K-12

MIDDLE GRADES ENROLLMENT PER SITE



EXPERIENCES VARY CONSIDERABLY

- Core subjects in blended classrooms
- Elective range varies widely
- Not all offer accelerated math
- Coaching, intervention, climate reduced
- Solo teachers, collaboration is hard
- PE, arts and STEM spaces vary

CURRENT STATE TO WELL-RESOURCED

A MIDDLE GRADES STORY (HYPOTHETICAL FUTURE)

THE RESULT

Resources balance out, so most 6th-8th grade students access the same high school preparatory experiences.



HOW WE GET THERE

01 Program shifts

02 Grade-band reconfiguration

03 School consolidation

HIGH SCHOOL PREPARATORY EXPERIENCES

- Daily grade-level core instruction
- Intervention and acceleration as needed
- Comprehensive range of electives
- Collaborative educator teams
- Streamlined feeder patterns
- Community and school partnerships

PORTLAND | Public Schools

QUESTIONS & DISCUSSION

Well-Resourced Schools - Rightsizing